

Aussie Primary Academy

Year 3 English – Writing: A Day at the Beach (Diary Entry)

I can: write a personal diary entry with descriptive language and my own feelings!

Name: _____

Date: _____

Page 1 – Learn & Practise

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Writer's Toolkit: Similes & Metaphors

A **simile** compares two things using "like" or "as" (e.g. "as brave as a lion").

A **metaphor** says one thing IS another to create a strong picture (e.g. "the classroom was a zoo").

Example: "The sand was as hot as fire" (simile) "The ocean was a sparkling blanket" (metaphor)

1 Vocabulary Bank — use these in your writing

sparkling

refreshing

sizzling

salty

adventure

memorable

splashing

golden

relaxed

thrilled

2 Warm-Up: Simile or Metaphor?

Read each sentence and write S (simile) or M (metaphor):

a) The waves were a rolling blanket of blue. (____)

b) The sand was as hot as coals. (____)

c) The seagulls cried like squeaky toys. (____)

3 Write your own simile or metaphor

Finish this simile: The waves crashed like _____.

Finish this metaphor: The beach was a _____.

4 Planning Organiser

When did I go?

Who was with me?

What did I do?

How did I feel?

5 Now write your diary entry about a day at the beach! (use "I" and past tense)

My Writing Checklist

- ☐ I used good vocabulary
- ☐ I used correct punctuation
- ☐ I included metaphors
- ☐ I included similes
- ☐ My writing is clear and complete

High-Five Tips for Parents & Teachers

Diary writing has no wrong answer — it's personal, so focus on encouragement over correction.

Ask 'how did you FEEL?' as well as 'what happened?' to build emotional vocabulary.

Check past-tense verbs together (went, played, saw) since this trips up many Year 3 writers.

A real memory (even a small one) is easier to write about than an imagined one.

Read it back together and add one simile or metaphor if it's missing.

✓ **Sample Answer Guide**

Warm-Up: a) M b) S c) S

Checklist: check for first-person past-tense writing, a clear sequence of events, at least one simile/metaphor, and a feeling word describing the day.